

## The Program in Action

When you run *magicfortuneball.py*, the output will look like this:

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```
M A G I C   F O R T U N E   B A L L ,   B Y   A L   S W E I G A R T

A S K   M E   Y O U R   Y E S / N O   Q U E S T I O N .

> Isn't fortune telling just a scam to trick money out of gullible people?
L E T   M E   T H I N K   O N   T H I S . . .

. . . . .

i   H A V E   A N   A N S W E R . . .

A F F I R M A T I V E
```

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## How It Works

The only thing the Magic Fortune Ball actually does is display a randomly chosen string. It completely ignores the user's question. Sure, line 28 calls `input('> ')`, but it doesn't store the return value in any variable because the program doesn't actually use this text. Letting users enter their questions gives them the sense that the program has an aura of clairvoyance.

The `slowSpacePrint()` function displays the uppercase text with any letter *I* in lowercase, making the message look unique. The function also inserts spaces between each character of the string and then displays them slowly, with pauses. A program doesn't need to be sophisticated enough to predict the future to be fun!

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```
1. """Magic Fortune Ball, by Al Sweigart al@inventwithpython.com
2. Ask a yes/no question about your future. Inspired by the Magic 8 Ball.
3. View this code at https://nostarch.com/big-book-small-python-projects
4. Tags: tiny, beginner, humor"""
5.
6. import random, time
7.
8.
9. def slowSpacePrint(text, interval=0.1):
10.     """Slowly display text with spaces in between each letter and
11.     lowercase letter i's."""
12.     for character in text:
13.         if character == 'I':
14.             # I's are displayed in lowercase for style:
15.             print('i ', end='', flush=True)
16.         else:
17.             # All other characters are displayed normally:
18.             print(character + ' ', end='', flush=True)
19.     time.sleep(interval)
20.     print() # Print two newlines at the end.
21.     print()
22.
```